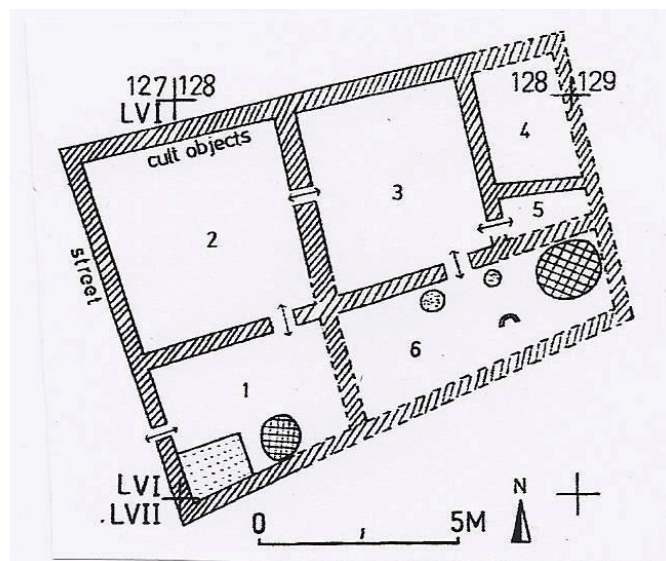


INTRODUCTION

1. The archive

1.2. The discovery of the archive

The archive published in this volume was found in the house excavated in grid square LVI/127-128, in level II of *kārum* Kanesh. T. Özgüç 1994, 369,¹ described it as follows: “The archive² covers an area of 130 m² and has its entrance on a north-south street. Burnt in a fierce conflagration, this building has also suffered damage from the laying of deep stone foundations for a superposed Ib house, and by insertion of a large stone cist-grave” (see T. Özgüç 1994, 372, plate I). Özgüç-Tunca 2001, 220, describe the house, which according to the ground plan shown below measures ca. 110 m², as “one of the largest and richest edifice(s) of the level II in Karum”. T. Özgüç, after dealing with a set of cult objects found in room 2, writes: “The archive of the merchant was found along the base of the east wall of room 3 and in rooms 4-5, in groups once packed in boxes, bags, sacks and straw mats. On top of each group lay one or two bullae. Unopened envelopes were placed at the bottom, tablets on top. In contrast to other archives, here we did not find tablets stored in jars”.



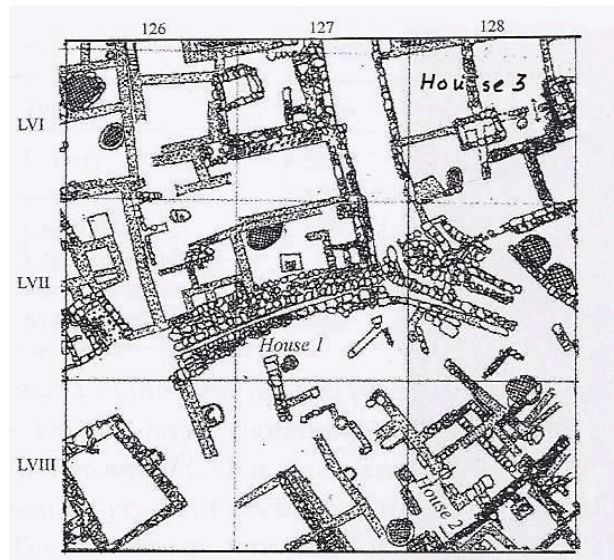
Ground plan of Elamma's house according to T. Özgüç 1994, 371, fig. 1.

During the 1991 excavation in all 427 texts were found and Tahsin Özgüç kindly provided me, both in writing and orally, with more detailed information on the archive. To his description I add a few pieces of information found by the present director of the

¹ A Boat-Shaped Cult-Vessel from the Karum of Kanish, in: H. Gasche *et alii* (eds.), *Cinquante-deux reflexions sur le Proche-Orient Ancien offertes en hommage à Léon de Meyer* (Mesopotamian History and Environment, Occ. Publ. II), Leuven 1994, 369-375.

² Note that the excavator uses this term as synonym of house.

excavation, Fikri Kulakoğlu, in the excavation records; they are marked by the letter K. Elamma's archive comes



Area excavated in 1991-1994, with houses 1 and 2 in grids LVII/127 and LVIII/127-28, where in 1993 and 1994 the archives of Elamma's brother Ali-ahum and his family were found; house 3 contained Elamma's archive (from AoF 35 [2008] 55).

from the second house excavated in 1991³ and its ruins yielded the texts numbered Kt 91/k 285-555 (K: found in Trench C, in different places). Four texts with numbers immediately preceding those of Elamma's archive, Kt 91/k 281-284, "were discovered on level II ruins" (orally: in debris of level Ib, mixed with remains of level II; K: in Trench A); they belong to a small native Anatolian archive and will be published elsewhere. At the very end of the 1991 season a few more texts were found: "Kt 91/k 556-561 in refuse (of level Ib?), 562-563 in level II, when cleaning the surface, and 564-568 in the open space between the houses" (K: in the courtyard ruin). Kt 91/k 556-561 probably all belong to a certain Šu-Bēlum⁴ and Kt 91/k 562-563 are two letters addressed to Nuhšatum by her husband Ennum-Aššur, which must have belonged to the latter's archive, published in AKT 3, which comprises more letters to her; they will be published in Veenhof 2014c. Kt 91/k 564-568 are fragments of sealed envelopes without text, whose seals will be published by Mrs. M. Omura; they are described in Ch. XXII, together with three such fragments found in Elamma's house.

Professor Özgüç told me that the excavation of Elamma's house was only completed in 1992⁵ and described the results obtained then as follows: "The discovery of the tablets collapsed on the floor of the south side of the second room (not mentioned in the article of 1994 – K.R.V.) has enabled us to describe the presence of a new Assyrian merchant with rich documents (Kt 92/k 94-187)." He also mentioned the discovery of the "isolated texts" Kt 92/k 3-5, which do not belong to Elamma's archive, but are included in this volume (as *147, *358 and *274) to make them available. The presence of an

³ The first house, according to T. Özgüç, was excavated in grid square LII-LIII/126-127 and yielded texts numbered Kt 91/k 112-246, which are designated by the excavator as «Archive 1».

⁴ See the introduction to Ch. XVI.

⁵ K mentions that in 1992 in all 862 texts were found; Kt 92/188-263 are the archive of Kuliya, published by me in AKT 5.

archive of “a new Assyrian merchant” probably applies to texts of Ennam-Suen, at least two dozen documents (letters and legal records, see below Ch. XIII), but room 2 also contained many records belonging to Elamma. The two groups of archival texts must have been stored separately, as the excavation numbers still suggests, for most of those between Kt 92/k 142 and 162 are records of Elamma, while most with numbers between Kt 92/163 and 181 belong to Ennam-Suen. In salvaging them they apparently were mixed up to some extent.⁶ Why and how records of Ennam-Suen ended up in a room of Elamma’s house is unclear. Somewhat deviating information, which distinguishes two groups, is found in Özgüç-Tunca 2001, 220, where these texts figure as “Archive III”, excavated in 1990-1991. They write: “It was deposited in the small room of the house” [room 4 or 5? – K.R.V.] and “one group of documents seems to have been packed in a bag or wrapped in some woven material”, while another group “was found in a burned wooden frame work which indicates that the tablets originally were on shelves”.

These pieces of information, in the absence of a detailed excavation report that links find spots and excavations numbers, are insufficient for classifying the archival texts according to their original grouping in the archive. We are not even told which tablets were found in rooms 3, 4 and 5 and which bullae “lay on top of each group”. Therefore the texts are edited here in a classification and order that tries to combine thematic (types of texts and transactions), prosopographical (focusing on writers and addressees of letters, parties in judicial records, creditors and debtors), formal (types of records) and chronological (based on eponymic years) criteria. These criteria of course may overlap and even conflict, in which case practical solutions have been chosen. It has resulted in presenting the texts in 22 groups (chapters), to which I have added an *Appendix* that presents the information on Elamma found in texts from other archives.

1.2. The composition of the archive

This volume publishes the 372 documents, including 7 bullae, that belong to the archive, and in addition the following texts that according to the information on their find spots (mentioned in § 1.1) and their contents almost certainly do not belong to it. Fragments of sealed envelopes, Kt 91/k 564-568 (= *361-365, in Ch. XXII), texts concerning Šu-Bēlum, Kt 91/k 556-561 (= *246-251, Ch. XV), and Kt 92/k 3-5 (= *147, *358 and *274), simply to make them available. I have not been able to study Kt 91/k 537 (a destroyed tablet) and Kt 92/k 170 (exposed in the museum). Kt 91/k 555, the eponym list KEL B, published in KEL 10-11 with fig. 4a, is not repeated. A tablet with two short incantations, Kt 91/k 502, will be published separately, and the two letters Kt 91/k 562 and 563, addressed to Nuhšatum and belonging to the archive of her husband Ennam-Aššur (edited as AKT 3), will be published in a *Festschrift* for Prof. Cahit Günbatti. The volume contains the archive as excavated, but we know that soon after Elamma’s death documents already were removed, notably by a certain Aku’a, son of Baziya, who took along two boxes with tablets (see *Appendix*, texts 1 and 7).

⁶ Kt 92/k 186 is a letter to Elamma, while 187 is addressed to Ennam-Suen. There is no record of how and where exactly these tablets were found. The two damaged bullae from this room, Kt 92/k 140 and 141 (*371-372) are of little help. Only the second bears an inscription, possibly “KIŠIB *Dan-A-š[ur]* / [DUMU *Na-a*]^{b2}-*Sú-ī[n]*”, but the two seals impressed on it (CS 182-183) bear no inscription and no person of that name occurs in the archive. CS 183 also occurs on VS 26, 115 as seal C, where it belongs to one of seven anonymous men who seal a verdict of the Wahšušana colony.

The texts can, as usual, be divided into three categories: a) letters, b) legal documents and c) a variety of memorandums, lists, notes, and drafts. Their numbers are in what follows preceded by “ca.”, because it is not always possible to categorize broken pieces. Numbers between brackets refer to those in AKT VIII.

a) There are ca. 109 letters: 37 (27%) are addressed to Elamma (of which 31 to him alone) and 11 are written by him, two of them with a co-writer. Several of the latter must be archive copies kept in Kanesh, but some were apparently sent to Kanesh by Elamma when he was traveling in Anatolia or visited Assur. Many letters were essential for the caravan system, other letters communicate various pieces of information and not a few of the latter were written when problems had arisen. The “caravan letters” consist of what Larsen has called “notifying messages” and “caravan accounts”, which inform the addressees, in Assur or Kanesh, that shipments of merchandise and money have been sent off or have safely arrived. In those from Kanesh Elamma may indicate what purchases should be made and those from Assur report on how the silver and gold that had arrived were used to buy merchandise, pay debts and which costs were made to equip a caravan. Family members of Elamma – his wife, a few sons, two daughters and a son-in-law – are represented by 20 letters, several of which seem to date from the time after his death. One (170) deals with the death of Elamma’s son Aššur-ṭāb, another (180) informs Šīmat-Aššur in Assur about the death in Kanesh of her mother and her two brothers and a third one (206) is a very personal and emotional one by Elamma’s daughter Ummī-lšhara, priestess in Assur, to her sister Šalimma, who refuses to join her husband Ir’am-Aššur, who has returned to Assur.⁷ There is also one by the just-mentioned Ummī-lšhara to her brother Pīlah-lštar, in which she tries to repair their relationship – he had left Assur in anger, after a row, and she “had not exchanged a word with him” – by apologizing and promising him two fine garments. A few letters (189-191), sent by Elamma’s son Ennam-Aššur from somewhere in Anatolia to the just mentioned Ir’am-Aššur in Kanesh, inform us about their at times problematic cooperation in the sale of textiles. In addition there are 11 letters written by and to Ennam-Suen, and 40 letters of many different writers and addressees, whose presence in the archive we cannot always explain. Some of them are interesting or informative, such as a letter by *kārum* Kanesh to “the travelers” (285), carried and used as credential by its messenger; a letter by Unapše, remarkable for its mention of a scribe “who understands the Shubarean (Hurrian) language”;⁸ and an emotional letter by Šat-Tašmētim, who tells about her misery and urges her addressees to come Assur in order to prevent harm to their “paternal house”. A few tablets are “second pages” of letters (without address, nos. 274-277), two letters are in unopened envelopes.

b) There are ca. 150 legal documents, 85 of which are witnessed contracts, among them 61 debt-notes, quittances and records of payments. The archive also comprises 4 sale contracts (of houses and slaves), 10 transport contracts (often related to the “caravan letters”), and 8 other contracts (about a joint-stock fund, guaranty, testaments). Of the remaining legal documents 32 are judicial records of various kinds, such as depositions, testimonies, records of summonses, mediation, arbitration and also a few verdicts and one oath. Finally there are 36 other witnessed records (about transport, agreements, settlements, promises, seizure, etc.). Of these “certified records” (*tuppum harmum*), preserved for their legal value, 45 are in sealed envelopes

⁷ See for this letter Veenhof 2007b.

⁸ Published by the present writer in Veenhof 2008c, 12-21.

INTRODUCTION

that remain unopened. This deprives us of important information, such as the contents of a testament (120), a declaration under oath (287), a verdict (196), and the data on a joint caravan of three traders, among whom Elamma (49).

c) Ca. 105 texts belong to the third category, documents without witnesses and never encased in envelopes. They range from big memorandums of up to 50 lines (69 and 70) to short notes on very small tablets with only a few lines of script (205, three lines). We have 14 large memorandums listing debt claims and 77 short memos and notes on investments, payments, textiles, losses, consignments, claims, silver, gold, the accounting of caravans (*ellutum*), transport, and travel expenses. Some of the latter (145-153) contain important information on the movement of caravans inside Anatolia, mentioning a few new place-names, among them what is called “the town of the Kaneshites”.⁹ In addition there are a dozen lists of textiles, silver, bread, and jars with beer (*kirrum*), a few bullae,¹⁰ and an eponym list, KEL B, mentioned above.

The archive comprises 57 tablets with envelopes, 9 of which were found opened, and 9 fragments of envelopes. On the envelopes ca. 190 different persons have impressed their seals (“KIŠIB A son of B”). Of the cylinder seal impressions, numbered CS 1136-1260, ca. 100 are new and there are 10 new stamp seals. They have been drawn by Mrs. M. Omura, who will publish them and together we managed to identify the owners of at least 75 seals.

The first six chapters of this volume present texts that certainly or very probably belonged to or concerned Elamma and shed light on his business activities and family relations. After a first chapter with some important “basic records”, the texts are grouped on the basis of their subject matter and/or their nature or typology, as the titles of these chapters show. It means e.g. that the (long) chapter with “caravan documents” contains in the first place many “caravan letters”, but also relevant transport contracts, memorandums and account texts, in addition to records about collective caravans (*ellutum*). The chapter on debt-notes (III) also contains big memorandums in which debt-notes are excerpted and an occasional quittance. A variety of letters that do not focus on caravans are presented in chapter IV and legal records of various nature are presented in Ch. V. After chapter VI on “memos, lists and notes”, chapter VII edits records specifying travel expenses, even though not all of them can be shown to concern Elamma’s business.

Elamma’s house also contained a number of texts that belonged to or concerned family members, notably Elamma’s wife and later widow Lamassutum (Ch. VIII), his children (Ch. IX) and especially two daughters, Ištar-lamassī (Ch. X) and Šalimma (Ch. XII), and also documents of the latter’s husband Ir’am-Aššur (Ch. XI). Many, but certainly not all, must date from the time after Elamma’s death and among them there are some files on particular events and problems, such as the one on Ištar-lamassī’s death, presented in Ch. X. They must have been left in or brought to Elamma’s house after his death, when his widow and some sons continued to live there for a couple of years. For a discussion of such questions and the implications and dating of these records I refer to the introductions to the chapters mentioned.

⁹ Some were already published and discussed by me in Veenhof 2006 and Veenhof 2008b. Traveling in Ancient Anatolia. Two New Sources from Karum Kanesh, in: B. Avunç (ed.), *Hayat I* also made them available to G. Barjamovic for use in his *Geography of Anatolia in the Old Assyrian Colony Period*, Copenhagen 2011.

¹⁰ Edited in Bullae 225-226 with pl. 107-109 and 340-293 with pl. 157.

A number of texts do not seem to have belonged to the archive of Elamma and his family, not only the two dozen texts of Ennam-Suen (Ch. XIII) mentioned above, but also ten texts of or concerning a certain Šu-lštar (Ch. XIV). In both of them the absence of patronymics, especially in letters, makes it difficult to identify the persons in question (who have very common names), as the introductions to these chapters show. Almost all Šu-lštar's texts bear excavation numbers between Kt 91/k 534 and 551, which also suggests that they were a separate group, deposited in the archive for reasons unknown to us, but the archeological record does not reveal where and how they were found. There are more texts whose relationship to Elamma's business and family is not obvious, among them a few contracts in which only Anatolians figure. Such texts find their place in the thematic text groups of chapters XVII-XXI. Further study, new sources and more prosopographic data in due time may reveal for more of them why they ended up in Elamma's. I have spent much time in trying to find answers to these questions, but the absence of a general OA prosopography and the existence of many unedited texts makes this difficult and time consuming. Further study would have unduly delayed the publication of Elamma's archive.

The last chapter, Ch. XXII, presents the fragments of sealed envelopes, including those (as mentioned above) that did not belong to the archive, and the bullae found in Elamma's house.

Continued study of the texts, after the format of the volume, the numbering of the texts and the indices had been completed, inevitably led to the discovery of a few more links between individual texts and possible identifications of persons. This should in a few cases have resulted in moving texts to a different chapter and renumbering them, which proved to be too complicated, although I did move a few texts, inserting them with an a-number. The links found are otherwise mentioned in the summaries of and notes to the individual texts.

2. Elamma and his family

Elamma, son of Iddin-Suen, was active as a trader for many years. His earliest dated transactions took place in the year REL 67, mentioned in the original contract *54 (where he was creditor as is shown by its excerpt in the memorandum *70:18-19) and in *74:15-19 // *75:10-12. The original contract *98 and the excerpts in memorandums *69:12-13 and *70:19-24 are dated to REL 75, while a settlement of accounts with Galdaya, recorded in the original contract *64, took place in REL 76. When he started his commercial activities is not known, presumably before REL 67, during the life-time of his father, possibly from the house in grid LVII-LVIII/127-128, which was later inherited(?) by his elder brother Ali-ahum. That Elamma's original service contract with Galdaya was found there (see the note to *70:5-9 and text no. 8 in the *Appendix*) could be an indication of it. When he became independent is unknown, probably after his father's death, when he inherited and the financial relation with his brother (cf. *1) was sorted out. Contracting a "harnesser" in REL 75 is a mark of success and this applies in particular to the acquisition in REL 78 of his own joint-stock capital (*naruqqum*), a copy of which is preserved as text *2. Several years earlier he may have built or acquired his own house and married, for debt-note *60 shows that already in REL 90, when Elamma was still alive, his (eldest?) son Aššur-ṭāb acted independently as creditor. It is excerpted in memo *69, which starts with five debt claims of Elamma, to continue in lines 42-51 with two of that son, dated to REL 95 and 90 (in that order). The latest

INTRODUCTION

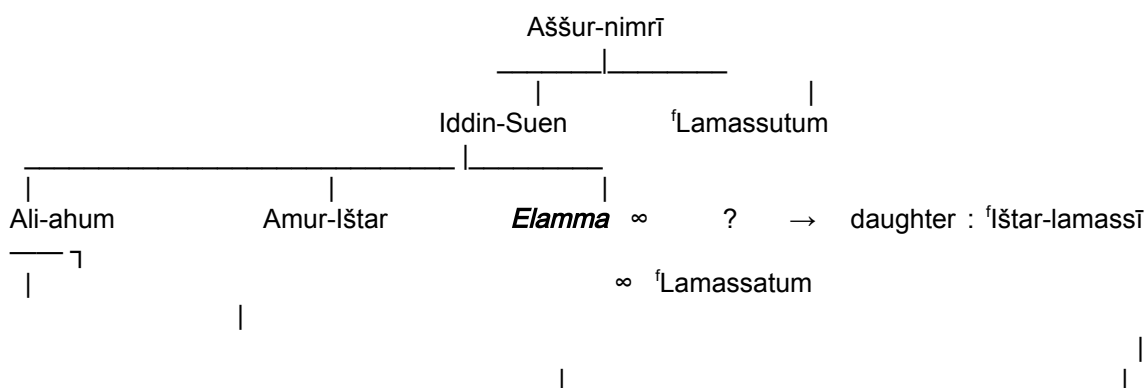
contract where Elamma figures as creditor is from REL 89, excerpted in *69:1-11, but this was not the end of his active life. He served several times as *hamuštu*-eponym since REL 83 (see AKT 1, 58A:7), the last time (as far as we know) during month VIII of year REL 92, recorded in VS 26, 94:6-12. When he died is unknown and the fact that according to *159, from month XI of REL 95, his wife featured alone as creditor (*159) does by necessity mean that he was no longer alive. He must have been dead when his son Aššur-ṭāb died, since he does not figure in the relevant documents (*170-172). That he does not appear in our sources after REL 92 implies that he died much earlier than REL 104/5, as I assumed earlier (see OAA 1, 187 comment on text 135 = *Appendix* text 1), but when exactly remains unknown.

Since the earliest dated contract from REL 67 hardly was the very beginning of his career and he died after REL 92, we may assume an active life as trader in Kanesh for a period of ca. thirty years. Texts 1 and 7 of the *Appendix* provide evidence of attempts by various people to get accesses to his strong room and archive after his death, but these sources are undated. He most probably died in Kanesh to be buried, as was usual, under his house, but due to the lack of an excavation report nothing is known about a possible tomb and the person buried in it that might support this idea and give an indication of his approximate age.

We can reconstruct the family tree of Elamma by using data from his own archive and those from that of his brother Ali-ahum, as reconstructed and discussed in Michel 2008, 59-63. The oldest part of the tree is due to her, since in Elamma's archive Iddin-Suen only occurs a few times as his father, but never as an active trader; it also does not contain documents of his. The three Iddin-Suen's who occur in the archive have different fathers and Elamma's father is also not identical to the Iddin-Suen who figures among the owners of imported textiles (see Ch. XXI) and partakes in caravans (his *awītum* in *150:3), who must be younger and he is also not the man who wrote three letters to Ennam-Suen (*211-*213). Since Ali-ahum was Iddin-Suen's eldest son (see the comment on *1), he probably moved into his father's house in Kanesh, which contained records from his father (see Michel 2008, 62).

Elamma's wife *Lamassutum*¹¹ figures in many texts (see Ch. VIII) and they document her involvement in matters of the family and her own activities, such as the purchase of slaves, extending small loans or granting credit, buying wool (for her textile production) and commer-

Family tree of Elamma



¹¹ Her name is spelled with and without vowel harmony as *Lamassutum* and *Lamassatum*; I use the latter spelling.

INTRODUCTION

her from Kanesh (see Ch. II, E, 3, and especially *8:13f. and *10:46), as writer of *165 and *206 and as addressee of *180. In *175 she is involved in dividing inherited assets with three brothers.¹³ A third daughter was **Šalimma** (Ch. XII), married to Ir'am-Aššur (see *207, and for him Ch. XI) and their marital problems are the subject of letter *206 (see Ch. XII). Her age is not known, but she may have been an early child of Elamma if Suhkana, daughter of Ir'am-Aššur, married off in Kanesh to a certain Aššur-mālik, was also her daughter. According to her letter *208 Šalimma probably also had two sons, Šu-lštar and Aššur-imittī, but both are difficult to trace due their very common names.

The “sons of Elamma” are mentioned as a group in *173:16 and *175. The eldest may have been **Aššur-ṭāb**, who already in REL 90 figures as creditor, in a memo that first lists debt claims of his father (*69:49-51). Identifying him is not easy, because the name is very common and he had a nephew of the same name. Elamma's letter *80 could have been written to him. He died early as reported in letter *170, addressed to Lullu (Ištar-lamassī's second husband) and his brothers Ennam-Aššur and Abu-šalim, who represent the interests of their dead brother in sorting out his inheritance according to *172, presumably for the benefit of Aššur-ṭāb's son Aššur-imittī, mentioned in *174:27-28. **Ennam-Aššur** is best known and presumably the oldest son after Aššur-ṭāb, because his name comes first in enumerations (before Pilah-Ištar and Šu-Bēlum in *174:26 and *175:1-3, where Ummī-Išhara is mentioned first; before Abu-šalim in *170:2 and *171:2). Due to his extremely common name and the presence of several namesakes in texts of the archive,¹⁴ it is not always easy to identify him. According to *89 his father, when he was to leave for Assur, had given him detailed instructions about amounts of silver that would arrive. He is later involved, alongside his mother, in the arrangements after Ištar-Lamassī's death (*180-182) and we have some letters addressed to his brother-in-law Ir'am-Aššur (Ch. XI, A), whom he addresses as “my father, my boss” (*189:58). As representative of his family, in the year REL 114 he sought arbitration in a conflict with a man who had received a “working capital of his father” (*173). He also figures, alone or together with one or more of his brothers, in the address of the letters *167-8 and *170-1, and together with Ummī-Išhara he reaches an agreement with two other brothers on the division of some assets from their inheritance in *175. Texts *176-7 deal with arrangements between him and his brother Ušur-pī-Aššur, apparently in connection with their father's (*bēṭ abišunu*, *177:5-6) and mother's (*176:11-14, *warka<t> Lamassatim*) inheritance. In these texts we also meet Elamma's son **Pilah-Ištar**, who features in the address of some letters and in several records (*174:26, but not in those dealing with Ištar-lamassī's death). In *165 he was in Assur, which he left with a caravan, in *166:26-28 he has to handle a load of wool that arrives in Kanesh under the seals of his brother, and *167 mentions that he will bring two donkey-loads of merchandise from Hahhum. Letter *89 tells that when Elamma left for Assur he sent amounts of silver (arriving in Kanesh) to his brother Ennam-Assur. **Šu-Bēlum** probably is “our Šu-Bēlum” of *77:3 (to whom 7 boxes with tablets were left!); he also features in *175, but remains

¹³ See for her also Ch. IX, with note 65.

¹⁴ The archive acquaints us with one who is the son of Iddin-Suen, in *185:2 involved in the arrangements after Ištar-lamassī's death, with a son of Aššur-dān, the representative of Ištar-lamassī's children (in *181-185), and a transporter of that name, son of Ditiya (*30:21-22). An Ennam-Aššur, in Assur, is one of Elamma's business associates, who appears in the address of caravan letters; a daughter of his could be share holder in Elamma's joint-stock capital (see *2:4-5).

rather elusive (see the remarks in Ch. XV). **Ušur-pī-Aššur** only figures only in *176-*178 in connection with his inheritance, mentioned above. Finally there is **Abu-šalim**, identified as son of Elamma in Kt 93/k 467:1 (courtesy C. Michel). He figures in the letters *169-*172 and is probably meant in *18:20-26, which suggests that he was a young boy living in Assur; Ēnah-ilī's remark "Abu-šalim will travel with me" (*28:20-21) could refer to the same situation. In *169:21-24 he transports merchandise in Anatolia together with his brother Pilah-lštar, but I hesitate to identify him with the man who brought silver to Assur in *41:10, probably the same man whose 4 textiles were on its way to Kanesh (bought by him as transporter?) in *38:28.¹⁵

Ir'am-Aššur, married with Elamma's daughter Šalimma (see for details Ch. XI) becomes rather prominent after Elamma's death. He occurs together with Lamassutum, traveled between Anatolia and Assur and, as mentioned above, cooperated with Ennam-Aššur. He had a house in Kanesh, where in the beginning of 1994 a small archive of his (ca. 60 texts) was found, but also had a pied-à-terre in Wahšušana (*203:5), where he had representatives (*189:21). He later lived in Assur, where his wife Šalimma was reluctant to join him (*206). His transactions as documented in texts found in Elamma's archive are of modest size.

Kūn-ilum (in what follows K.), son of Iliya (see TC 1,107 = EL 272; Kt 87/k 274:1; 318:4-5; Kt 91/k 141:36), after whom he called his eldest son, was another son-in-law of Elamma, the first husband of his daughter lštar-lamassī (*183:2-3, *183:7-8, *187:7; see for details Ch. X); he must have died well before REL 90. Since the name is not very common, I assume that the references in Elamma's archive are to him. He was a trader and there is evidence of mutual services and some cooperation with Elamma, but the nature of their business contacts and his own his activities are not very clear. According to *19:10 he had a transporter (*rādi luqūtim*) working for him (cf. TC 2, 16:14),¹⁶ and in *94:5-10 we read about merchandise of his brought by Ēnah-ilī, which entered the palace. *80:10-13 shows that K. himself is shipping a number of textiles and *335:11-13 mentions that "7 minas of tin belonging to K. were brought away by Aššur-ṭāb". Merchandise of K. traveled in Anatolia with a caravan, for in *81:30-31 Elamma mentions that 6 minas of the tin he had paid to the colonial authorities as *šaddu'utu*-tax were for K.'s account (*kišdāt* K.). *121, recording Elamma's contribution to and deposit in the colonial office, also mentions "11 shekels of silver for 1 *kutānu*-textile of K" (a deposit probably made for him by Elamma). K.'s involvement in such transactions is confirmed by *351:6-9, which mentions "in all 3 ½ minas have been booked in K.'s name in the colonial office" (adding that 2 of the textiles deposited there belong to K.), and *352 mentions "3 minas 37 shekels of silver, K.'s share. He probably also features in Kt 91/k 153, where he settles accounts with Puzur-lštar and the latter asks him about "the copper, the price for his textiles", apparently because K. had taken care of their sale.¹⁷

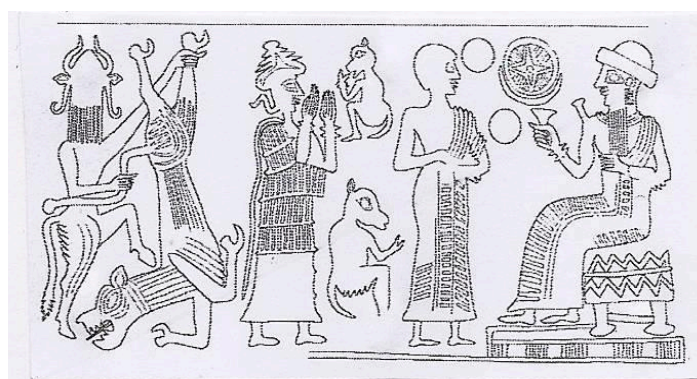
¹⁵ According to *124:15 one Abu-šalim bought 7 garments; Abu-šalim's also occur in *255:19 and *270:5.

¹⁶ The man is called "the son of Ahatum" and in Kt 87/k 318:1-7, Amur-ilī confronts "the slave of the son of Ahatum" with the fact that he had made him bring 2 donkeys loaded with textiles to Kūn-ilum.

¹⁷ Other occurrences of K. are in BIN 4, 119:4; CCT 1, 19b:14; 2, 28:9-11; 5, 7b:3; they show his trading activities and contacts with Pūšu-kēn and Hinnāya. According to TC 2, 16; 23:9-10 he was in Durhumit and Prag I 676 (a letter by Hinnāya to Pūšu-kēn) i.e. 1-2 states: «I he (a debtor) is in Durhumit, let one seize [him in] the house of lštar-pilah and Kūn-ilum!». He also figures in texts 20-21 of the *Appendix*.

INTRODUCTION

The information on Elamma's sons is rather limited and haphazard and mostly undated; the latest dated texts are *173, from REL 114 and *281:18f., from month VIII of REL 115. It is not clear to which extent and how they continued the commercial activities after their father's business had been liquidated. There is some evidence of cooperation, also between Ennam-Aššur and his brother-in-law Ir'am-Aššur, but we have no letters documenting the traditional caravan traffic between Assur and Kanesh. Ennam-Aššur traveled a lot in Anatolia and letters sent to Ir'am-Aššur (*189-194, see Ch. XI, A) show that he was involved in the trade, but the transactions are modest. On two occasions he supplied Ir'am-Aššur silver (ca. 3 and 1¾ minas, "sent from Hattum" and "given in Hurama") to buy for him tin in Assur, the yield of which had been used to pay an unidentified creditor of his in Assur, (the letters present different versions of what happened, see Ch. XI, A, interpretation). He was Ir'am-Aššur's agent or junior partner in



*The seal of Elamma as impressed on texts *49, *99 and *120 (drawing Mrs M. Omura).*

selling textiles for him, but he complains about not being paid the expenses incurred and the letters show that he had financial and perhaps other problems and felt mistreated by his brother-in-law.¹⁸ Since it is unlikely that these letters were archive copies made by Ennam-Aššur, they probably belonged to Ir'am-Aššur and somehow found their way to Elamma's house. This leaves the possibility open that Ennam-Aššur by that time stayed elsewhere in Anatolia, which could explain the lack of more documents on his commercial activities. The little we know of Pilah-Ištar's activities has been mentioned above. Elamma's widow, according to *164, still could leave behind to her children silver objects, cash silver and debt-claims with a total value of ca. 8 2/3 minas of silver, alongside textiles and slaves and presumably her house in Kanesh. And *175 shows that during the year REL 107 there were still assets of the inheritance to be divided between four of Elamma's children. But the general impression is that they could not carry on as their father had done.

The latest dated texts dealing with the family are *173, from REL 114, when Ennam-Aššur sought arbitration (mentioned above) and *281:18f., from month VIII of REL 115, where he features as witness of a legal confrontation in Hurama. Texts *300//301, dated to the end of REL 116, concern a debt-claim of the wife and sons of Elamma's brother Ali-ahum, but no members of Elamma's family feature as witnesses.

¹⁸ See *190:35-37 and the question in 46-48, "What misdeed against you have I committed?" Note also words in 45-46, "Allow me to see the face of Aššur and of you", which could mean "make it possible for me to come to Assur without being ashamed".

Text *286, from month XI of REL 118, has no apparent link with the family. The end of the archive therefore fits the picture drawn in *Ups and Downs*, 64ff., with figure 16a on “archives ending around 108-112”, where also possible explanations for this remarkable feature are discussed.

3. The business of Elamma

Elamma's business consisted of two kinds of activities. The first and main one was the ongoing import from Assur and sale in Anatolia of woolen textiles and tin; the second was the trade in copper inside Anatolia. The skills these activities required were probably first acquired when assisting his father Iddin-Suen, accompanying caravans and helping in the sale of the goods in Anatolia. When he established himself as an independent trader he had a sound financial basis in the share in the considerable inheritance left behind by his father (text *1). Already before the year REL 76 he enlisted the services of a “harnesser”, essential for caravan transports (*64).¹⁹ His initial successes must have inspired confidence and have qualified him to acquire in the year REL 78 a joint-stock capital (text *2) of nearly 28 pounds of gold, the equivalent of ca. 100 kilos of silver. He himself and his two brothers made ca. 9 pounds of it available, four named persons (Hinnāya, Iliya, Šu-Labān and a daughter of Ennam-Aššur) almost the same amount and merchants who wished to remain anonymous (designated as *tamkārum*) slightly more than 10 pounds. The contract records, probably as security for the investors, Elamma's own “capital”, consisting of 1500 measures (standard jars of 30 liters?) of barley, 2 slaves, a “share”, and “pots”, i.e. smaller, specified funds. The “share” must have been still undivided assets of the inheritance, owned jointly with his brothers, items designated in some texts as being “of the paternal house” (É A.BA), such as the silver mentioned in *3:24-25 and *17:20-21. The joint-stock fund also comprised a small share (1 1/5 pound of gold) qualified as the joint property of him and his brother, presumably also a still undivided item of their father's inheritance.

Elamma's caravan trade is reflected in the so-called “caravan documents” (Ch. II). It could only be carried out with the help of various persons, those who equipped the caravans in Assur, those who led them between Assur and Anatolia, and men who took care of the sales and purchases in Anatolia, in a wide area that a trader in Kanesh could not cover alone and for which he needed men who traveled with the merchandise “in the countryside” (called *eqlum*) or were settled in one of the many other colonies and who may have acted as a kind of agents.

3.1. Investors and representatives

The men to whom the shipments of silver sent to Assur are addressed and who equip the caravans we meet as the writers and recipients of “caravan letters”. Those addressed to Elamma come from Aššur-rēšī (3, 27, 37, 38, 39), Dadiya (3, 27, 34-40, 90), Ennam-Aššur (3, 27, 35-40, 90), and Iliya (3, 39). Note the statement in 87:6-9, “Šumi-abiya is on his way to you with letters of Dadiya and Ennam-Aššur”. The same men also receive letters from Elamma: Iliya (6:3) Aššur-rēšī (6, 16, 18, 79), Dadiya and Ennam-Aššur together (16-18, 79, 81), and occasionally Agū'a (81), Ali-ahum (Elamma's brother), Atāya (79 and 81), Iddin-abum (81), and “my investors” (16). As

¹⁹ This text, a settlement of accounts between him and the harnesser, Galdāya, mentions at the end: “Separately there exists a certified record of his working capital”, which implies that this service contract was somewhat older.

INTRODUCTION

the destination of the silver sent to Assur, also mentioned in transport contracts, we meet “my investors” (7:4; 8:3; 9:4), Ali-ahum (8:29, 35), Aššur-rēšī (8:8, 29), Dadiya (8:8, 20:24, 29, 35) and Ennam-Aššur (8:8, 20:25).

Elamma’s **investors** (*ummiānū*) are mentioned as recipients in *8:4 and *9:4, in the address of letter *16, and in *7:4-6 they occur alongside “my representatives and Hinnāya”. They probably are the merchants who had shares in Elamma’s joint-stock capital (*2), but it surprises to find Hinnāya, investor in *2, singled out in the address of *7. This happens also with Ali-ahum in *8, where the first shipments of silver is “for my investors” and the second and third are “for Ali-ahum and Dadiya”. Since “investors” always appear as an anonymous group it is difficult to identify them, but I assume that there were more persons than those listed as such in *2. Perhaps from a second joint-stock contract or long-term loans (*ebuṭṭum*) or investments in specific undertakings. After Elamma’s death his “investors and representatives” figure as addressees of text 1 of the *Appendix*, where they are informed about an unsuccessful attempt by another group of men, also acting “under the responsibility of the investors” (lines 27-28), to gain access to Elamma’s strong room in order to take along “all silver and copper there is”.

Representatives of Elamma in Assur most probably were **Aššur-rēšī**, **Dadiya** and **Ennam-Aššur**, mentioned above. They must be meant by “my representatives” (*šazzuztia*) in *79:25 (see the note on this line). Only the transport contract *7:5, exceptionally, mentions that silver was sent to Assur “to my investors, my representatives (*ša kīma jāti*) and Hinnāya”. They were no family members, but merchants in Assur, whose identity remains unclear. They receive the silver Elamma sent to Assur and equip the caravans for him and also borrow silver for him for that purpose (*16:9-13, *27:4-6, *38:9-12). They figure as recipients of small amounts of silver (usually less than 1 mina) sent to Assur (*10:30-33; *12:17-20; *20:15-19), apparently payments for the few textiles they had given along to Kanesh to be sold there for them (in *10:29-33 qualified as “the price paid for his textiles”; cf. *38:29-30; *40:26-27).²⁰

Iliya, the first investor in *2, who heads the group in *3 and *39 (cf. *6:3) too gives textiles along and gets paid for them (*9:13; *12:8f., called his *tadmiqtum*; *15:11, *20:15). He obviously is a senior and when he appears Ali-ahum is absent. He probably was less a representative of Elamma than a business partner and *102:5, “Iliya, one of you^{plur}”, considers him to belong to Elamma’s firm; he was the father of Lā-qēp (*102:4-5, cf. *64A:1), with whom Elamma also had business contacts (see below § 3.3). Several texts reflect Iliya’s own commercial activities. *12 states that a shipment of silver (to which Elamma had added four packets) was sent to Iliya and Lā-qēp’s representatives in Assur and *43:6 mentions merchandise of him with a value of 4 talents 18 minas of tin. *129 lists 96 textiles of his and *128:2 records a balance payment by him for textiles, because he had taken part in a joint caravan or in connection with a deposit made for him in the colonial office. Letter *81 deals with the taxation by the colony of merchandise considered to belong to Iliya and mentions “silver belonging to that of his joint-stock capital”.

A certain **Atāya** was another contact or friend in Assur, who figures alongside Elamma’s representatives in his letters *79 and *81, and as first addressee, alongside family members of Elamma, in *180, a letter sent to Assur by Lamassutum and others

²⁰ *91:21-24 tells Elamma that Aššur-mūtappil is bringing him 2 *kutānu*-textiles under the seal of Dadiya.

in connection with the death of Ištar-lamassī. The end of *79 is addressed to him alone where Elamma, who calls him “my brother” (l. 24) mentions a free loan (*tadmiqtum*) entrusted to his father – probably Bušiya, mentioned as such in *168:2 - and asks him to assist his representatives in Assur. As a reward (“I will do you a favor”) he suggests him to send a few textiles to Anatolia, which (this is implied) Elamma will sell for him; the 35 shekels of silver Atāya obtains in *35:13-14 from what Elamma sent to Assur may be the outcome of this offer. *42:6 also mentions a *kutānu*-textile of him shipped to Anatolia, and *35:34-35 mentions a larger sum of silver he had “taken” and had probably entrusted to Elamma’s representatives.

3.2. “Transporters”

Traders needed “transporters” to lead their donkeys or caravans, whose activities are described in the caravan documents by means of the verb *wabālum*, “to bring, deliver” (with and without ventive), *radā’um*, “to lead (donkeys)”, and “to carry” (*našā’um*), normally in the stative, “he is bringing, he has with him”. An important category were those called “harnesser” (*kaššārum*, often with added “of PN”), who had been engaged by a service contract that supplied them an interest-free working capital (*be’ūlātum*).²¹ Others, called *sāridum*, “packer”, were hired for a special stage or as supplementary personnel. Others again presumably were young traders or free-lance transporters. The names of those attested in Elamma’s caravan texts are listed in the tables in Ch. II, E, where one finds two dozen different men. Most prominent are Aššur-nādā, Dān-Aššur, Šallim-Aššur, and Šu-Kūbum, but only Šallim-Aššur is attested as a “harnesser”, because he has received a “working capital” and a clothing allowance (*36:16-20). This is not said of Šu-Kūbum, who according to this very letter brings the silver to Assur, but he probably is the “harnesser” whose 3 textiles are mentioned in l. 24; his “working capital” may not have been mentioned, because he had been contracted earlier. Text *19 lists a series of payments to men called *rādi luqūtīm* of various traders, that is men “who drive (donkeys loaded with) merchandise”, and they are distinguished from two called “harnesser” (lines 17, 24). The presence of “harnessers” is also clear when the load comprises some “textiles of the harnesser”, because they regularly used their capital for buying and taking along to Anatolia textiles, which they could sell with profit in Anatolia. Elamma’s archive contains a few service contracts with such men (*65-67) and there are many references in the caravan accounts to silver supplied as “working capital” to them. Several probably were active in the same period and some may have started as “harnesser” to become junior traders in due time. This applies to some sons of well-known traders, probably designated as “junior/affiliated traders” (*mer’ū ummiānim*), whose services according to many letters were preferred for the shipment of silver. Examples are Dān-Aššur, son of Šalim-ahum, and Aššur-nādā, son of Aššur-idī, mentioned as transporters in *38:4-7. The absence of dates (transport and service contracts are rarely dated; few debt-notes survive because they usually were discarded when the contract ended and the silver was paid

²¹ See for such contracts Veenhof 1994.

back)²² does not allow a chronological approach. See for data on transporters also Ch, II, e, 4.

An important man in the caravan traffic was also **Ē/īnah-ili**. He brought silver to Assur (*13:21), 11 donkeys with tin and textiles to Elamma and Kurub-lštar (*28) in Kanesh, and in *31//32 he entrusted three donkey loads of merchandise of the same men to Iddin-Aššur. He also transports merchandise of Kūn-ilum (*94:5) and in *82 Elamma and Kurub-lštar instruct him and a certain Dada to buy tin and textiles with the silver shipped to “their father”. This last reference shows that he was more than a trusted transporter, which is confirmed by *174, where he took 8 minas of silver, acting for (*kīma*) Elamma.

3.3 Business associates

Elamma had many business contacts and a large number of people occur in his records. Several of them occur only rarely or are just names to us, and here I focus on the more important and frequently mentioned ones. They are not called his “partners” and are no family members and their status is therefore not very clear, apart from those who had invested in his joint-stock fund (see *2), such as Hinnāya, Iliya (discussed above) and Šu-Labān; Lā-qēp, son of Iliya, was already mentioned in § 3.1. Larsen in OAA 1, xxxvif., dealing with such merchants in the archive of Aššur-nādā, calls them “(close) business associates” or writes “that some bond existed between them”.

Kurub-lštar

An important business associate was Kurub-lštar,²³ co-addressee of Elamma (who is always mentioned first) in several letters, including *94, a letter by Kūn-ilum. Iddin-Aššur asks them in *31-32 to decide what to do with several donkey loads, “your^{plur} merchandise”, entrusted to him by Ēnah-ilī, and in *8:27-28 Elamma speaks of “silver belonging to me and Kurub-lštar”. This is also the case with silver and merchandise mentioned in *34, while in *82 Dada and Ēnah-ilī write them about silver “brought to you^{plur}”. But cooperation did not mean their merchandise was always merged, for in *28 Ēnah-ili first writes them on loaded donkeys “I am leading to you^{plur}”, and next, addressing Elamma alone, on a large shipment that “I am leading to you^{sing}”. *129 lists textiles of both men separately (alongside those of Iliya) and *128:5 mentions a balance payment by him. Puzzling is *40, a notifying message from Assur about purchases made for Elamma, which mentions in lines 22-25 “20 shekels of silver, working capital of K., 2 shekels his clothing allowance, 3 textiles belonging to him”, perhaps comparable with *130:9-13, “117 dark textiles entered the palace, of which 2 are the share of K.” If this is the same man, he must first have been employed as “harnesser”, to become later a kind of junior colleague, perhaps reflected in the mention in *127:13 of merchandise “shipped under his responsibility” (*ša šēp* K.)? This

²² The survival of such a contract in its envelope (*66; cf. *EL* 97, the oldest surviving contract) could imply that the debt was never paid back. This may also be the case with the early contract with Galdaya (see *Appendix* text 8 and the note on *70:5-9). Contract *67 (a tablet without envelope) is a special case, because the *kaššārum* Aššur-imittī received a second “working capital” (after the earlier one recorded in *70:3-4, which was cancelled according to *67:16-18) and the new contract states his cumulative debt, 63½ shekels of silver. Other *be’ūlātu*-contracts in this volume are *160 (of Lamassutum), *200 (of Ir’am-Aššur) and *312/3 (employer not mentioned).

²³ See for him also OAA 1 xxxvi, on his cooperation with Aššur-nādā.

seems possible if we can identify him with “K., son of Ali-ahum” (who occurs also in *Appendix* text 28), hence a nephew of Elamma, who is mentioned in *175:5. There a debt of his of 4 minas of silver (no doubt owed to Elamma) is an item in an exchange of inheritance shares between children of Elamma. But C. Michel’s reconstruction of Ali-ahum’s family tree the family does not include a Kurub-Ištar.

Lā-qēp(um)

Another associate was Lā-qēp(um), son of Iliya, already mentioned above, but their relationship and its financial basis is not very clear. Outside the archive he is a.o. known from BIN 4, 168:4-5, where he figures as owner of 5 talents of tin and participant in a very large caravan (*ellutum*) of Pūšu-kēn. In *35:8-9 Lā-qēp acquires (*ilqe*) part of the dividend (*šipkātum*) that accrued to Elamma from his brother’s joint-stock fund and *114 records that Elamma sent Lā-qēp silver to the value of the latter’s outstanding claim (on him?). In *81 Elamma reports that he can indemnify himself for taxes levied by the colony from Iliya’s silver, from his joint-stock fund through(?) Lā-qēp; *100:7-9 mentions donkeys belonging to him and Elamma and in *20 Elamma tells him that he sent him (from somewhere in Anatolia) a large amount of silver, which Lā-qēp has to forward to Assur. In *15 six donkeys loaded with tin and textiles are entrusted to him, presumably by Elamma, and *24 states that a similar load was delivered (in Kanesh?) by Lā-qēp’s [caravan]. In *42 Lā-qēp and Šu-Aššur inform Elamma about a substantial lot of textiles and tin, apparently delivered to them (in Kanesh?), which three transporters will bring him. Lā-qēp features several times as owner of textiles in texts of Ch. XX, in particular in *322, and in *22 Elamma is informed about amounts of silver of Lā-qēp, paid out and owed to him, and he is asked to «let his silver go to Lā-qēp». In *67:14, *68:15, *126, and *199 Lā-qēp acts as witness for Elamma in various situations (debt claims, a settlement of accounts, an agreement). Since there were many men called Lā-qēpum it difficult to know which of the many occurrences in Elamma’s archive refer to our man.²⁴

Hinnāya

Elamma also cooperated with Hinnāya, «an important trader of high status, active in Assur and Anatolia» (OAA 1, xxxvi). The two had invested in each other’s joint-stock fund (*2:11-14 and *4:4-20) and took care of each other’s interests, such as the shipment of silver and merchandise, both in Assur and Anatolia, also in storing money and documents in each other’s strong room and they occasionally settled accounts. Text 12:13ff. of the *Appendix* mentions textiles «taken in the name of Elamma and Hinnāya», and l. 39 «silver of Elamma and Hinnāya», and 15, 17 and 19 are letters written by Hinnāya that mention transactions and liabilities of Elamma. Hinnāya could have been a partner (*tappā’um*) of Elamma, but his status is never defined. From text 1 of the *Appendix* we learn that a particular debt-note of him had been deposited in Elamma’s strong room and in *21 he asks Elamma to store in his strong room a container with a large amounts of silver and gold. Several texts document their cooperation in shipping silver and buying or selling merchandise, either in Assur, in Kanesh or elsewhere in Anatolia. In *89 Belānum and Hinnāya tell Elamma that, after he had left for Assur, they saw to it that three large amounts of silver of his were sent after him, and from Assur Elamma informs Hinnāya in *30 that a shipment of tin and

²⁴ Lā-qēpum occurs among the recipients of bread in *142:15 (50 pieces) and *310:5-6 registers a debt of his of 2 minas of silver plus interest.

INTRODUCTION

textiles is on his way to him. In *26 Hinnaya reports the arrival of a shipment of textiles Elamma had sent him and also tells him (lines 34-36) that he will sell textiles of his «that are in Zimišhuna». In *7 we read about silver sent to Assur, to Elamma's investors, representatives and Hinnāya, and in *36 Elamma is told that merchandise the latter have bought is on its way to him. A memo of Elamma, *44:34-40 mentions that 4 donkey loads of tin and textiles, part of a larger shipment, are brought to Hinnāya, who seems to be active outside of Kanesh; according to *91:7-8 he had a house in Durhumit. Some form of cooperation is also implied by *5:10-14, where Elamma, Hinnāya and Aššur-kāšid are said to have a share (*admū*) in Šu-Anum's caravan and texts 2-6 of the *Appendix* reveal how three traders, including Elamma, each took one third of 4 talents of tin of Hinnāya that had arrived with Aššur-taklāku's caravan, to sell it for him. The operation was apparently delayed or mishandled, so that after Elamma's death Hinnāya by juridical means and with the help of colleagues (he wrote two letters on this issue to Pūšu-kēn) tried to get back what he was entitled to. Such joint activities and mutual help - in *19 Elamma lists many small payments he had made for Hinnāya by sending silver to the latter's transporters - required settling of accounts. *121 mentions balance payments» (*nīplātum*) by Hinnāya (to Elamma?) and *122, with the subscript «About Hinnāya's account», mentions a balance payment, presumably to be made by Elamma (see the comment on these texts) and the settling accounts by the latter in Hinnāya's name (*aššumi* H.), presumably in the colonial office. Unclear is *175:4-5, where among the assets to be divided by children of Elamma we find «6 2/3 minas of silver, the house of Hinnāya», presumably a debt still owed (after Hinnāya's death) by his household.

The status and identity of many other men who cooperate with or have business contacts with Elamma and render services for him is often unclear.²⁵ Contacts with Aššur-idī and his son Aššur-nādā (whose archive was published in *OAA* 1) are documented in various texts, see *Appendix*, comment to text 2-5, 12-15 and 20-21 (two letters written by and addressed to them jointly); in *38:32-34 he transports merchandise from Assur to Elamma. For some writers of the letters presented in Ch. IV we may suggest an identification,²⁶ but many, represented by one letter only and without patronym, remain just names. A certain **Aššur-mālik** in *22-24 informs Elamma, who is apparently outside Kanesh, that he has shipped the silver and tablets Elamma had sent him to Assur and had arranged various payments of silver. He also reports about what happened with a shipment of textiles that arrived from Assur, part which (25 dark textiles) was brought to Elamma (lines 17-18). The same Aššur-mālik presumably features in text 23c, a joint letter of Elamma and him, and 23d, both dealing with the sale of textiles, and possibly in 25c. According to *125 Elamma “checked and handed over (*isniq*) to us” an amount of more than 14 minas of silver, the price of two donkeys loaded with tin and textiles. This seems to mean that he acquired it by giving those who had (bought it for and) delivered it to him what it had cost in Assur, but who the “us” are is not stated. Texts *102-105 document a conflict with a certain Pilah-Aššur about a transaction in tin, for which Elamma offered to give him silver and which he would buy in Assur and bring to Kanesh, no doubt to make a profit from selling it in Anatolia.

²⁵ Text 19 of the *Appendix*, a letter of Hinnāya, shows that Elamma and a certain Ibni-ilī both, and perhaps jointly owed silver (ca. 4½ minas) to Šalim-ahum.

²⁶ Aššur-nādā and Aššur-imittī of *85 and Aššur-rēī of *86-87 could be the transporters of these names.

3.4. Elamma, a licensed trader and participant in “caravans” (*ellutum*)

The figures collected in the lists in Ch. II, E record the shipment of in all ca. 300 kilos of silver and small amounts (twice 2 minas, once 33 shekels) of gold²⁷ to Assur and the purchase or import of ca. 1400 kilos of tin and ca. 1350 textiles into Anatolia. This is hardly the grand total of Elamma's transactions, considering the number of records preserved and the number of “transporters” attested in memorandums and debt-notes, who do not figure in caravan accounts and letters. It is also likely that the usually undated documents – apart from memorandums that record debt claims – cover especially the later years of Elamma's activity. Moreover, as texts 1, 2 and 7 of the *Appendix* show, records were removed from his archive after his death. If we extrapolate the amounts of silver, 50 and 75 pounds, mentioned in transport contracts *8 and *10 (in both cases by three different transporters) and read about loans taken out in Assur to make purchases (30 pounds of silver in *16, see the note one lines 9-13), we may assume bigger amounts/numbers. The merchandise imported from Assur, as the table of Ch. II, E § 3 shows, consisted of between 2 and 7 and most frequently of 4 donkey loads. This meant, starting from 2 donkeys loaded with tin and 2 with textiles, an investment for merchandise, donkeys, harness, personnel, travel expenses and export tax of ca. 30 minas of silver, while its net yield, after deduction of tolls, taxes and expenses, also depending the quality of the textiles, may have been ca. 45 pounds of silver. How many such transactions were carried out by or for Elamma and how much profit he made during his active life is impossible to say.

Elamma apparently was a well-organized, careful and successful trader, with a steady import and turnover of a good size, although apparently less rich and powerful than men like Pūšu-kēn, Imdī-ilum or Šallim-Aššur. It is very likely that he belonged to the category of “*dātum*-payers”, a kind of licensed traders, who paid substantial, apparently annual contributions (called *dātum*) to the colony as an institution, who were also called “men of the (settlement of) accounts” and for that reason were exempt from paying the *šaddu'utu*-fee to the Kanesh colony (see for them and the *dātum*, *OAI* Ch. 6 and 7 and my observations in *AKT* 5, 85-87). Elamma is never called a “*dātum*-payer”, but there are good arguments for considering him one. The amount of silver mentioned for him in *121:1-6 (24 1/3 minas of silver plus some additions)²⁸ and the mention of deposits made at the colonial office (e.g. in *140) and of “balance payments” made at

²⁷ Two letters of Hinnāya to Elamma, *21:5 and *26:37-38, mention 2 minas of gold (in *26 «given» to Ištār-pilah) to be sent on to Assur. In *20:4//*37:8, together with much silver, 33 shekels of gold are brought to Elamma for this purpose. *37, which reports its arrival in Assur, mentions that the recipients had to pay the import-tax on it and that the gold was converted into silver (at the rather low rate of 5¼ :1) in order to make purchases for a caravan. The memo *124:16-17 mentions the *šaddu'utu*-tax on 2 minas of gold, alongside 48 minas of silver. Amounts of 15 shekels occur in *7:18, *8:6, and *17:5 as payments to persons in Assur. In *268 (not related to Elamma) we read about *pašallu*-gold in the shape of rings, with difficult data on its rate of exchange (see the comment on this text) and in *333 deals with the import-tax on 43 shekels of gold and its use after conversion into silver.

²⁸ Alongside a similar amount for Šu-Kūbum, comparable to that of 25 minas 15 shekels for Hinnāya in *122, a record “about Hinnāya's account” (see the comments on these texts and *OAI* 226).

INTRODUCTION

the settlement of accounts to reach the amount of the *dātum*,²⁹ fit his status as “*dātum*-payer”. Moreover Elamma’s words to the colonial organization in letter *81:19-21, “The merchandise belongs to me, why have you levied the *šaddu’utu*-tax?” almost prove it (see the comment on it).

As a member of the colonial establishment Elamma also cooperated with other traders by taking part in large, collective “caravans” (*ellutum*), organized and led by one merchant, who took care of its organization and administration (which apparently included clearing the imported merchandise in an Anatolian palace, paying taxes, meeting expenses, etc.).³⁰ An impressive testimony of this is the record *5, which registers that Elamma³¹ had a “deposit” (*nadī*) or share (*adim*) in seven different caravans, in the first three caravans together with Šalim-ahum, Ali-ahum + Hinnāya, and Aššur-kāšid, next in four caravans (including one of Pūšu-kēn alone).³² Other such caravans in which Elamma had a share or invested are those of Ali-ahum (*35:4), of Aššuris-tikal (*19:20-21), of Ennam-Suen (*53:3), of Ilī-ālum (*113:5-6, mentions its expenses and losses), of Innāya and Šu-Nunu (*47:9-10, losses), of Pilah-Ištar (*51:12-14), and perhaps of Lā-qēp (*24:5).³³ The amounts of silver *5 mentions (ranging from 15 ¼ shekels - Elamma alone - to 4 2/3 minas - Elamma and Ali-hum) are not the value of his merchandise that traveled with the caravan, but what he was entitled to as a result of settling accounts. It included what was due by the palace, where the merchandise had been cleared (lines 5-6 and 30-31, *ina ekallim nadī / adim*; in lines 26-26 specified as “55 shekels of silver for 2¾ *kutānu*-textiles”, probably bought by the palace, at 20 shekels apiece).³⁴ Additional evidence of cooperation in such caravans is found in Ch. II, D, where *49 (unfortunately in an un-opened envelope) lists the “declared value” (*awītum*) of the merchandise of Elamma, Susāya and Ennam-Sin”, which suggests that goods of these three cooperating men was part of a caravan, whereby its declared value may have served as basis for charging them their share in the costs etc. Compensation for losses by a caravan was also paid (*127, see also *128, with comments). The final yield a merchant would derive from such a caravan is specified in texts such as *51-53, which either simply mention amounts in silver or, in *51, the merchandise for which it was paid. Other records may also concern cooperation in a “caravan”, e.g. the list of in all 306 textiles in *129, simply mentioning the number of pieces owned by (“of”) Iliya, Aššur-lamassī, Kurub-Ištar, and Elamma. It may have

²⁹ Cf. OAI 222, “When the value of the deposits had been registered and the amount of the *dātum* to be paid was known, every merchant could calculate for himself what his credit was and how much, if necessary, he had to balance. Balance payments (*nipiltum*) were made to the colony often by person other than the shareholder”. See for a balance payment made to Ali-ahum, while the silver actually is for Hinnāya, text 15 in the *Appendix*.

³⁰ See OAI, Ch. 9, on the ‘caravans’.

³¹ The text used the third person (*adim*) and once the first person singular (*admāku*, l. 23), but both must refer to him.

³² Text 25d of the *Appendix* lists ca. 4 minas of tin belonging to Elamma, part of a large amount (more than 4½ talents) qualified as “*sa’ud/tum* of Ali-ahum, son of Aššur-mālik, of the caravan of Pūšu-kēn”.

³³ The names of the men who organized or led such caravans are listed in OAI 165. This list also mentions caravans of Ali-ahum and Elamma himself, which would occur in *1:14-15, but the word *e-li-ti-a/kā* here in my opinion is not *ellutum*, but *elītum*, the name for a specific share in an inheritance.

³⁴ See for such dealings with the palace also *Appendix* text 24f, on textiles of Elamma from the caravan of Ali-ahum, bought by the palace, and 25a, on silver of Elamma on deposit in the palace.

registered how many pieces each participant owned after the load had been cleared. Some of the lists of textiles owned by named persons (among which Elamma does not figure) and presented in Ch. XX may have a similar background, because they also mention how many were handed over as import-tax, were sold by pre-emption, were used for wrapping or were lost – typically features reflecting the procedure of clearing incoming merchandise in the local palace. The fact that the number of textiles of the individual owners is listed on one tablet suggests that the clearance concerned a joint caravan, whereby the resulting shares of each participant were registered.

How exactly these “caravans” operated still raises questions and we would like to know how a merchant’s participation in it was (contractually?) arranged. How does participation in such “caravans” relate to what letters (called “caravan accounts, type 2”) tell a trader about his loaded donkeys, which a named transporter is “leading/bringing to you”. It is highly likely that small groups of donkeys would not travel alone, but that at the gate of Assur large caravans were formed, when donkeys of different traders, each accompanied by one or more “harnessers” or transporters, would join to make one big caravan. Was this a “caravan” (*ellutum*) of the type described above, organized, led and administered by one or two named traders, or was it a less organized, practical form of cooperation, different from such an *ellutum*? The former seems rather likely, but the “caravan accounts type 2” also report on the clearance of the merchandise in the local palace, payment of taxes, pre-emption of textiles by the palace, and balance payments in connection with the levy of taxes. This is different from what records about the accounting of an *ellutum* report, which mention that traders have deposits in and claims on the palace for what it had bought. The above-mentioned system of the “declared value” (*awītum*) as the basis for calculating and charging each participant a proportionate share in the costs, is not used or referred to in the “caravan accounts type 2”. This makes identification of the two types of caravans therefore difficult and raises the question how big Elamma’s participation in such “caravans” was, difficult to establish since most of the evidence we have refers to balance payments and claims of rather modest size. Here *50 is important, which deals with the “declared value” of a shipment of merchandise of Elamma alone, amounting to 4 talents of tin. On the basis of the standard values in tin for textiles and donkeys (see OAI 152) this could have been one donkey load of tin and two of textiles, which is in the range of what the caravan accounts tell us. Such a small group of loaded donkeys, accompanied by one harnesser (Kunnāya), must have been part of a larger caravan, perhaps an *ellutum*.

3.5 Commercial activities in Anatolia.

While we have good evidence for Elamma’s imports of tin and textiles from Assur, we know very little of their sale in Anatolia. We read about small numbers of textiles given to or taken by various persons (among them family members and personnel), about tin and textiles taken by the local palace as import tax (*nishatum*) and about its purchase of the textiles (“the tithe”). Textiles are also textiles “deposited” in the colonial office and there are payments of limited numbers of textiles in connection with settling of accounts (in *121-122 and *128). But what happened with the bulk of the tin and textiles cleared is never mentioned. We have no “caravan accounts of group 2” (so called in OACP 122ff.), letters written in Kanesh that mention that substantial lots of merchandise, often with the donkeys that carried them, were given in commission (*qiāpum*) to agents and

INTRODUCTION

on what conditions (price, credit term, date).³⁵ We read in *26:34-36 that Hinnāya will sell textiles of Elamma that are in Zimišhuna, and in *80 Elamma writes to Aššur-ṭāb (his son?), who is somewhere in Anatolia, that Kūn-ilum is bringing him 6 1/3 heavy textiles and that Elamma will send him thin and Šulupkian textiles. As for the tin we have a few letters and contracts that shed some light on its sale. In *102 Elamma offers Pilah-Aššur tin (presumably 2 talents), for which he will give him, within 20 weeks, silver at a rate of 8:1, and in *107, Šu-lštar is summoned by him to pay at first 12 1/2 minas of silver for the tin – its amounts must have been in the range of a few talents – he had acquired from Elamma and the rest later. The contract *106 states that from “his tin that comes up” (from Assur) Elamma will send 2 talents to Šu-lštar in Burušhattum, who will pay him silver as soon as he gets it. Several men who figure in debt-notes and memorandums may have been granted credit for merchandise bought from Elamma, but most amounts owed are modest (see the table at the end of Ch. III; for 1 mina of silver they could have acquired 6-8 minas of tin and 3 or 4 textiles) and there are not many of more than 2 minas of silver. The highest are 3 minas, due by Aššur-lamassī, son of Lā-qēp in *69:4-5³⁶, more than 4 minas by Idnāya in *55 = *6-10, and 8 1/2 minas by Šuli in *70:19-24.³⁷ If these debts reflect credit sales most of them concern only small quantities of merchandise.³⁸ We may assume that Elamma himself traveled with merchandise inside Anatolia, as his son Ennam-Aššur later did according to *189-194 (albeit with textiles of Ir'am-Aššur), *ina libbi mātim* or in Hattum (*189:18, 39) and visiting Wahšušana (*189:22), Hurama (*191:26), Luhusaddiya (*191:40), and Šaladuwar (*194:15). I consider it probable that some of the records 145-147, presented in Ch. VII, «Traveling and travel expenses», are the result of such caravan journeys in Anatolia, although this is difficult to prove, because they do not mention a single name of a transporter or trader and therefor may as well concern Elamma as one of his sons. Elamma may also have «given» merchandise to agents or associates for sale in Anatolia, as shown by letter *25, which informs Elamma about the fate of tin and textiles of his he had “given” to Aššur-mūtappil, who brought the tin to Burušhattum, while the textiles were “brought back” to Wahšušana. We also have some letters addressed to and written by Elamma when he was outside Kanesh (*20-25, *42) and it seems very likely that he stayed or traveled there in order to sell the merchandise he had imported, but where or to whom and at which prices is not mentioned. There must have been cash sales to native Anatolians, which do not yield

³⁵ Such “caravan accounts type 2” are fairly rare and the two most detailed ones, BIN 4, 27 and 61, are in letters addressed to Šalim-ahum. This is explainable because he was the owner of the merchandise and apparently keen to receive detailed information on what happened with his merchandise upon arrival in Anatolia. Elamma, on the other hand, himself was its owner and there was no need to inform his representatives in Assur about the sale of the goods that had arrived.

³⁶ The original debt-note is presented as text 9 of the *Appendix*. Whether this Aššur-lamassī is meant in other occurrences, such as *68:18 (has to confirm for Elamma the liability of two traders for 11 textiles), *79:18, *128:9, *129:4 (12 textiles of him), *174:7 (witness), and *303:10, is not clear, for several men of that name occur in the archive. One, the son of Ennumāya, was a “transporter” in *35:22-24 and he may also appear in *3:10-11, *9:20-21, and perhaps in *42:10.48 (*šēp* A.). See for a third Aššur-lamassī, son of Ali-ahum, the remarks on seal B of *15.

³⁷ Dated to REL 75. Here Šuli is the son of *I-li-li*, but in *69:12-15, dated to the same eponym year, the debt is 8 minas and Šuli is the son of Puzur-Abel!

³⁸ Kt 94/k 135, presented as text 9 in the *Appendix*, is a debt-note for perhaps 3 minas of silver owed to Elamma by lštar-lamassī, from the year REL 89.

written evidence, while Elamma's debt-notes and memorandums on outstanding claims mention almost exclusively Assyrian debtors, which shows that he did not sell at credit to Anatolians. The only exception is a modest debt of 48 minas of copper owed by Habtuniš (*70:14).³⁹

We have to be careful in reconstructing Elamma's commercial activities and his turnover from the written evidence in the form of debt-notes and memorandums. Credit sales and commission of merchandise to agents usually were for short terms, ranging from a few weeks to one year. It is plausible that most such debts, also under the pressure of the substantial default interest, were duly paid, which meant that the debt-notes were returned to the debtors or at least their envelopes, which gave them their legal force, were broken. Of the debt-notes preserved in the archive (*54-*63, *65-*66) five are tablets (among which *55, the only one for a somewhat larger debt), which have no legal force and may have been preserved by the creditor for his administration after the envelope had been broken.⁴⁰ Seven (including *65-66, contracts for borrowing a «working capital») are still in their envelopes and accordingly may be assumed to have been old debts, never paid,⁴¹ but they record small debts (ranging from 10 to 61½ shekels of silver, and 50 minas of copper). This suggests that all the other debts resulting from credit sale and commission were duly paid and therefore have left no trace in the archival documentation as we have it. Most of the debts listed in the memoranda were apparently overdue, but were eventually also paid, because the valid debt-notes of only a few of them were found in the archive. This leads to the conclusion that debt-notes and memorandums only offer an incomplete picture of the commercial activities of a trader. It can be supplemented by caravan letters and other accounts, but the resulting picture remains patchy and incomplete.

Copper owed to Elamma is mentioned in one debt-note (*61) and several memorandums, in particular in *76, which records at least 15 claims for in all ca. 20 talents of copper, most of good quality. Many claims concern amounts of less than 1 talent (30 kilos), some 2 to 3 talents (*70:1f.; *76:8, 10, 15); 4½ talents were due by Iddin-Aššur in *69:18ff., ca. 5 talents by Iddin-Amurru in *70:26f. and *73, 2½+3 talents by Ganunu in *76:1-2, 9 talents by Šu-lšhara and Puzur-Abēh in *307, and 11 talents by Dazū'a-^dIM in *70:34.⁴² If these debts reflect credit sales of tin and textiles that agents took on consignment, the amounts, with some exceptions, were not big, considering that one textile (depending its quality and its sale to a palace or an

³⁹ The identity and ethnicity of "the son of *Da-zu-a*^dIM" (*70:34) is unknown. The native Anatolian (*nuā'um*) who in *72:6-7 owes 39 shekels of silver and a textile, could be the second husband of Elamma's daughter Ištār-lamassī, who is often designated in this way. A certain Šiumiar, who in *258:11-25 owes copper as price of a golden bead and an amount of tin, probably also was an Anatolian.

⁴⁰ This must be meant by the verb *laṭā'um*, "to split", see the note by Larsen on AKT 6, 671:16.

⁴¹ Unless the validity had been canceled by issuing a sealed quittance, which usually includes the statement that if the original debt-note turns up it is invalid (*sar*, cf. *67).

⁴² See for copper debts not owed to Elamma *302:15-27, a debt of 5 talents of refined copper owed by two Assyrians to Lipit-Ištar, payable in 5 years; a debt of "9 talents of refined, broken copper from Haburata" (see for this quality *Copper* 215 and 217), payable within 3 months, is owed in *307 by Šu-lšhara and Puzur-Abēh (perhaps to Elamma, because Puzur-Abēh also owes him copper in *70:33).

INTRODUCTION

individual) could yield 15-40 minas and 1 mina of tin ca. 10 to 15 minas of copper.⁴³ They also reflect a pattern of many sales to many different people. An interesting transaction is described in the contract *289 (which does not seem to concern Elamma), where one Aššur-ṭāb has promised Ahu-waqar 1 talent of tin from Assur. He will get it when Aššur-ṭāb's servant brings tin from Assur and he pays for it 5 talents of «refined, broken copper», which implies a high rate of exchange of 5:1 in Kanesh. A credit sale is also recorded in *307 (see footnote 38).

The fact that almost all debtors were Assyrians suggests that Elamma (or his employees), when he traveled sold them tin and textiles at credit for copper, presumably in area of Durhumit, the centre of the copper trade, where they could acquire it. That Elamma himself visited Durhumit is confirmed by *61, which records a claim of copper and silver on Puzur-Suen. If he defaults he has to pay interest «according to the regulation of the Durhumit colony», to which the last lines add: «If he does not pay I will take it for his account in Durhumit».⁴⁴ A few texts, nevertheless, show that at times considerable amounts of copper were involved. In *25 Aššur-mūtappil tells Elamma that 35½ talents of copper were shipped to him (presumably Elamma) under his and Aššur-ṭāb's responsibility (*iššēp A u iššēpia*). From text 1 of the *Appendix* we learn that after Elamma's death his strong room contained both silver and copper (how much is not stated). In *171 Elamma's nephew Aššur-ṭāb (the same man as in *25?) acknowledges the sale of 21 talents of refined copper belonging to Elamma's recently died son Aššur-ṭāb (which had been deposited in his house) for almost 18 minas of silver, which he is bringing to Assur. Copper was used for various transactions in Anatolia, such as purchasing slaves (*154:1-2, *258:37-38) and for paying travel expenses (*145), but it was in the end converted into silver and gold that was shipped back to Assur, and this must also have been the goal of Elamma's trade in copper.

Elamma's commercial activities were not restricted to dealing in tin, textiles and copper. There are no references to the expensive meteoric iron (*ašium, amūtum*), nor to trade in grain, but wool, traded in Anatolia, and lapis lazuli, imported from Assur, occur. In *47:7-8 Aššur-imittī, probably writing from Kanesh to Elamma elsewhere in Anatolia, having reported the arrival of silver under Elamma's seal, writes: «We paid 3 minas of silver for wool of the colonial office». This is probably not a simple purchase, but a payment to subscribe to a collective undertaking organized by the colony to acquire wool.⁴⁵ In *169 a certain Ušur-ša-Aššur is reminded of the fact that the writer had entrusted him, seven months ago, 4 talents of wool loaded on 2 donkeys, «belonging to the *tamkārum*», to be converted into silver, which two sons of Elamma should bring him. Sale of wool for copper is also mentioned in *240:4-7 (not related to Elamma), and *72:41-42 mention 4 talents of wool were «left behind in the house». Wool was not only sold, but also used and *159 records that an Assyrian owed

⁴³ See *Copper*, 228-229. The prices for tin show not too much variation, but those for textiles do. Prices of 30 and 32 minas apply to what deposits in the colonial office yield, that of 40 minas to a sale to a palace. *86:2-6 mentions that Šulupkean textiles were «taken» by a transporter for 30 minas of refined copper. In TPAK 1, 143 one paid in Assur 2 talents of copper for 4 textiles of very good quality.

⁴⁴ There were also other methods of acquiring copper. *137 mentions a debt of 2½ minas of silver owed by Puzur-Ellil, part of which "I" obtained in the form of more than 2½ talents of copper. The background may have been a credit sale of tin and/of textiles for silver, but (in part) paid in copper.

⁴⁵ See for this procedure *AOATT* 134ff. and for the trade in wool now Lassen 2010.

Lamassutum «30 minas of soft wool for making the weft», which she must have used for weaving textiles, such as the *pirikannu*-textiles that she had entrusted to her son Pilah-Ištar to sell them (*164:20-22). Lapis lazuli is mentioned in letter *47:20-26, where Elamma is told: «Of your lapis lazuli, which they brought here, they (apparently the colonial authorities) took as tithe⁴⁶ 53 shekels (which implies a total amount of ca. 9 minas); they bought 32 shekels at a rate of 2:1», adding that the well-known transporter Bur-Suen is bringing him the silver.⁴⁷

4. The format of the edition

The format and style of this volume are basically the same to those of AKT 4. The personal and geographical names in the translation and the index of names are rendered in the standardized way on which we have agreed in the Old Assyrian Text Project – e. g. *I-na-/En-na-/En-nam-/E-num-/En-num-Sú-en/in* are all rendered as Ennam-Suen; *I-dí-Sú-en/in* as Iddin-Suen, *A-lá-hu-um* as Ali-ahum, and *I-ku-pí-Ištar* as Ikūn-pī-Ištar – to ensure that the same person does not feature under different spellings in the translations and index. The index in several cases indicates abnormal or rare spellings and those interested in them can find them in the transliterations. The year eponyms are identified by numbers preceded by REL, based upon the list presented in *Ups and Downs*. The names of the months in translation are rendered by Roman numerals (Bēlet-ekallim = I, etc.), *hamuštum* by “week”, IGI introducing witnesses by “witnessed by” or “in the presence of”. KÙ.BABBAR, “silver”, is always abbreviated as KÙ.B. and the “translation” of the figures used for its weight are occasionally adapted, so that e.g. *1 ma-na LÁ 2 GÍN* is rendered by «58 shekels», and *1½ GÍN 22½ ŠE* by «1½ shekel», etc. *Kārum* is translated by “colony” and *bēt kārim* by “colonial office”; *wabartum* is “trading station”. A *mer’a ummiānim* is an “affiliated trader”, *tamkārum* is often left untranslated (in letters addressed to or written by and debts owed to *tamkārum*), but in other cases by “agent” and “creditor”. *Naruqqum* is rendered by “joint-stock fund/capital”, *tadmiqtum* by “free/friendly loan”, and *be’ūlātum* by “working capital”.

In transliterations of envelopes the presence of seal impressions between the lines of text or on one of the edges is indicated and the different seals used are numbered by capital letters, starting with A at the top of the obverse («seal A», etc.). After the transliteration the seals, as far as possible, are identified by giving their number, preceded by CS (cylinder seal) or St (Stamp seal), in the system developed by Nimet Özgüç and carried on by Masako Omura. Notes on the seals identify their owners and their use on other envelopes, but there are no descriptions or drawings, since they will be provided in a volume with new seal impressions, including those on the envelopes found in Elamma's archive, which Mrs Omura is publishing. For the benefit of the philologists and the students of the seals, I have tabulated the seals, their owners and the sealers mentioned on the envelopes in two tables in Ch. XXIV.

Symbols and conventions used in the transliterations and translations

[*um-ma*] missing signs whose restoration is (virtually) certain.

⁴⁶ See for the tithe on lapis lazuli, payable to the colonial organization, AKT 5, 82-85.

⁴⁷ *339 mentions silver, the price of lapis lazuli, sold in Šuppiluliyā and owed to the anonymous writer by the colony of Durhumit.

INTRODUCTION

[x (x)], °x x _c many	missing and/or damaged sign(s); the number of x's indicates how many
?	average sized cuneiform signs could be restored in the gap.
x*	uncertain reading of a sign.
XXIII.	the asterisk refers to the drawing of difficult and damaged signs in Ch.
<x> , <<x>>	signs mistakenly omitted or added by the scribe.
:	the "word dividing" wedge used by some writers.
/	marks off signs belonging to a word at the end of a line that for lack of
space	are written at the end of the next line.
[	marks off parts of long lines indented in the transliteration or
translation.	
!	correct reading of malformed or wrong sign, occasionally followed by
[X]	which gives the sign the scribe mistakenly wrote.
<i>italics</i>	uncertain translation.
(goods)	words added in the translation to make explicit what may not be clear.